

on your system. You can turn the preview mode off inside the capture wizard.

▣ Decrease The Display Settings

Try setting your display to a lower resolution (1024 x 768 is WMM2's minimum recommendation, but you can go lower if you need to) and decrease your colour depth to 16 million (or 'high colour').

Save Project Files Correctly

 When you first save a project in WMM2, the program generates a 'movie maker project file' on your hard drive. You can name and save this project file anywhere you want, though WMM2 will attempt to place it within your 'My Movies' folder.

The project file is a 'linking file' that keeps track of every item in your home movie. This includes every video clip, song and picture; the project file knows where each of these items are located on your computer, how they are laid out on the movie timeline, and what effects and transitions should be applied to each.

However, these video objects are not actually embedded within the project file. The project file only links to the actual multimedia files. Because of this, you really need to organise all your files if you ever want to re-edit your project.

Why? Suppose that sometime in the future you decide to give your computer a spring cleaning, and you reorganise some of your media files. You can damage a project if you inadvertently move or delete a file that is used in one of your videos. The next time you open up your video project, WMM2 won't find the media file where it expected to find it, and your project will be forever ruined.

To avoid this problem and keep your project intact, we recommend creating a new folder for each of your video projects. You should then save every movie element into this folder before you import them into WMM2. This folder should include your captured video,

background music, pictures, voice narration, and the project file itself. With all your files together like this, there is no chance of a file being inadvertently deleted or moved. Plus, this method allows you to easily transfer your entire project to another computer (or backup onto an external hard drive).

Don't underestimate the importance of organisation when it comes to editing video. Unless you stay on top of things, your hard drive can quickly become cluttered with random video clips and pictures, and you won't know what's safe to delete.

How To Remove 'Junk' Video

 The most useful aspect of computer video editing is that you can weed out all the 'junk video' that finds its way into everyone's home movies. There are many kinds of 'junk video' that you might want to remove from your home videos:

1. Zooming

Overzealous use of the camcorder's zoom function is the number one sign of a beginning videographer. Zooming tends to make your audience sea-sick and should only be used for framing shots

(i.e. zooming between recorded scenes). Fortunately, you can edit these zooms right out of your videos and only show the wide establishing shots followed by close-up shots.

2. Preparing To Speak

If you are filming a narrator or filming a family member, there's always that couple of seconds where they say "OK... is the camcorder running?" Now you can cut that part out and start right with your interview.

3. Stillness

Good video needs motion and action—basically, something happening. For example, if you are filming a birthday and it takes your child two minutes to open his birthday present, consider cutting out the middle 1.5 minutes. Your audience wants to see the motion: your child's delight at seeing the present, and the triumph of getting it open.

There are several ways to get rid of junk video, and a video editing program like WMM2 makes it easy.

4. 'Manual Capture' Only The Video You Want

When you transfer digital video from a camcorder to your computer, WMM2 gives you the option of 'manually capturing' your video, letting you decide exactly what sections of your tape you

want to transfer. This allows you to capture only the parts of your video tape that you want in your finished move, thus saving you a lot of precious hard drive space.

5. Cut Clips

WMM2 allows you to cut your video clips in half. This is a great way to get rid of large chunks of junk film. You cut your clips in two different places within the program: both in the preview monitor, and also while working on the timeline. Simply find the location you want to cut and click the 'Cut' located under the preview monitor.

6. Trim The Ends

For the finest control, you can trim the ends off your clips by setting the exact in and out points of each video clip. While working on the timeline, simply drag the ends of each clip to the exact point you would like it to start and stop. You can accomplish very fine control of each clip's start/stop points by trimming, especially if you zoom in on each clip using the magnifying glass.

Video Effects

 WMM2 comes preinstalled with a number of video effects you can add to your movie clips. These effects are numerous and easy to apply. Despite the large assortment of effects, you'll find yourself using certain effects more often, and some of them not at all. Here are some of the most useful effects and some uses you might not have thought of.

1. Brightness

These effects are very useful for fixing your video's exposure levels. If you filmed an indoor scene that looks too dark, you can simply brighten the video with the brightness effect. If your video still isn't bright enough, you can repeat the effect several times until you get the look you want.

2. Greyscale and Sepia

Both these effects remove the colour from your film, and the sepia effect gives your film a pleasant 'yellowed old photograph' look. You can use these desaturating effects to



Illustrations Harsho Mohan Chatterjee